Ashish Pandla

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linkedin Portfolio website



PROFILE SUMMARY

Chartered accountant and finance leader with 8+ years of post-qualification experience driving FP&A, financial controlling, and corporate governance across high-growth startups and MNCs (Cars24, Cargo-Partner). Proven track record in AOP formulation, multi-entity Ind-AS/IFRS financial closures, cross-border restructuring, and automated P2P/O2C ERP rollouts. Trusted partner to executive leadership, optimizing working capital and turning around regional P&Ls.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Manager (India Lead) - Controlling/Business Finance **08/2023 – Present**

Cargo Partner Logistics India Pvt. Ltd. (Subsidiary of Nippon Express) *Gurugram*

- **Annual Operating Plan (AOP) & Board Reporting:** Managed annual budgeting and rolling forecasts for business divisions, created integrated 3-statement financial models, Capex/Opex allocation frameworks, and board presentation decks to support executive decision-making.
- **Financial Modeling:** Developed end-to-end financial models and live MIS dashboards (budget vs actual, sales rankings, KPI trackers) to enable data-driven decision-making.
- **Cost Optimization:** Led strategic cost-control initiatives across cost centers, identified operational leakages, and achieved annual savings of approximately ₹50 lacs.
- **Revenue Assurance:** Implemented cross-functional revenue assurance audits across business verticals, tracked profit-center billing accuracy, corrected revenue leakage, and engaged with operations to safeguard gross margins.
- **P&L Turnaround & Unit Economics:** Developed detailed contribution-margin and unit economics frameworks for all regions & branches and led performance turnaround initiatives that turned about 75% of previously losing profit centers and increased operational productivity by 20%.
- **Business Partnering:** Collaborated closely with business heads to co-pilot strategic growth, margin improvement, and cross-functional operational efficiency.
- **Working Capital Management:** Optimized receivables, payables, and cash flow to maintain liquidity and efficiency.

Senior Manager/Finance Controller **12/2019 – 08/2023**

Cars24 Services Pvt. Ltd. *Gurugram*

- **Month-End Closing:** Streamlined monthly and annual book closure, ensuring compliance with key accounting standards and compressing the closing deadlines (from the 11th to the 7th day).
- **Corporate Finance & Equity Restructuring:** Led end-to-end execution of a $10 million ESOP share buyback and managed cross-functional workstreams across independent share valuation, board approvals, and withholding tax (TDS) calculations in compliance with Ind-AS 102/32 and the Companies Act.
- **Financial Analysis:** Managed cost variance analysis and end-to-end revenue assurance audits to eliminate financial leakage, enforce strict spend control, and safeguard margins.
- **Audit & Due Diligence:** Led statutory, tax, and Internal/ICFR audits in coordination with external auditors (EY, GT), resolving critical control deficiencies and high-risk observations to achieve a 100% clean internal audit report.
- **Cross-Border Structuring & Capital Allocation:** Partnered with leadership to execute international market entry, managed capital structures, FEMA/transfer pricing frameworks, and robust financial controls to support high-growth overseas expansion.
- **Financial Transformation & Automation:** Led the implementation of scalable ERP and BI frameworks (SAP S/4HANA, Power BI), automating critical P2P/O2C workflows.

- **Inventory Management:** Managed end-to-end inventory controls across vehicle hubs and refurbishment yards, governed periodic physical verifications, Ind-AS 2 cost vs. NRV valuations, aging provisioning, and shrinkage reconciliations.
- **Team Leadership & Process Optimization:** Structured and managed a 10-member transactional finance team (AP/AR/GL/Taxation), established standardized SOPs, stringent maker-checker matrices, and internal financial controls (IFCs).

Audit Executive **01/2019 – 12/2019**
N K Jain & Co. *Gurugram*

- **Internal Audit:** Conducted end-to-end internal audits, including physical verification, to evaluate operational and financial controls.
- **Audit Planning & Execution:** Designed audit plans, testing procedures, and reports to ensure robust assessment of financial statements and internal controls.
- **GST Compliance & Filings:** Led preparation and filing of GST returns and audits, ensuring full regulatory compliance.
- **Process Implementation:** Established and streamlined GST compliance processes in line with regulatory requirements.
- **Advisory & Research:** Provided expert guidance on GST laws through detailed research, ensuring accurate and timely client advisory.

EDUCATION

Chartered Accountant (CA) **2018**
The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India
55%, Exemption in AMA, ISCA, SFM

Master of Commerce (M.Com) **2016**
Rajasthan University
50%

Bachelor of Commerce (B.Com) **2014**
Rajasthan University
61%

EXPERTISE

- **Strategic Finance & FP&A:** Financial Planning & Analysis, Budgeting & Forecasting, Variance Analysis, Fundraising, Working Capital, KPI Dashboards, Business Partnering.
- **Financial Controlling & Governance:** Ind-AS / IFRS, ICFR Framework, Financial Reporting, Consolidation, Cross Charge, Statutory & Tax Audit, ESOP Buyback, Internal Audit, GST Compliance, Transfer Pricing.
- **Systems & Process Automation:** SAP S/4HANA, SAP B1, Cargowise Certified, Power BI, Tableau, Advanced Excel, Salesforce, Tally Prime, and Antigravity.

AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

Cargo-Partner
- GEM Award recipient (2024, 2025, 2026) and Top Support Function Award in Process Excellence **(2024, 2025).**

Cars24
- Employee of the Year (2021); Detail-Oriented Excellence Award (2022)

Performance Ratings
- Ranked in the top appraisal tier (Outstanding/Excellent) across all cycles (2021–2026)